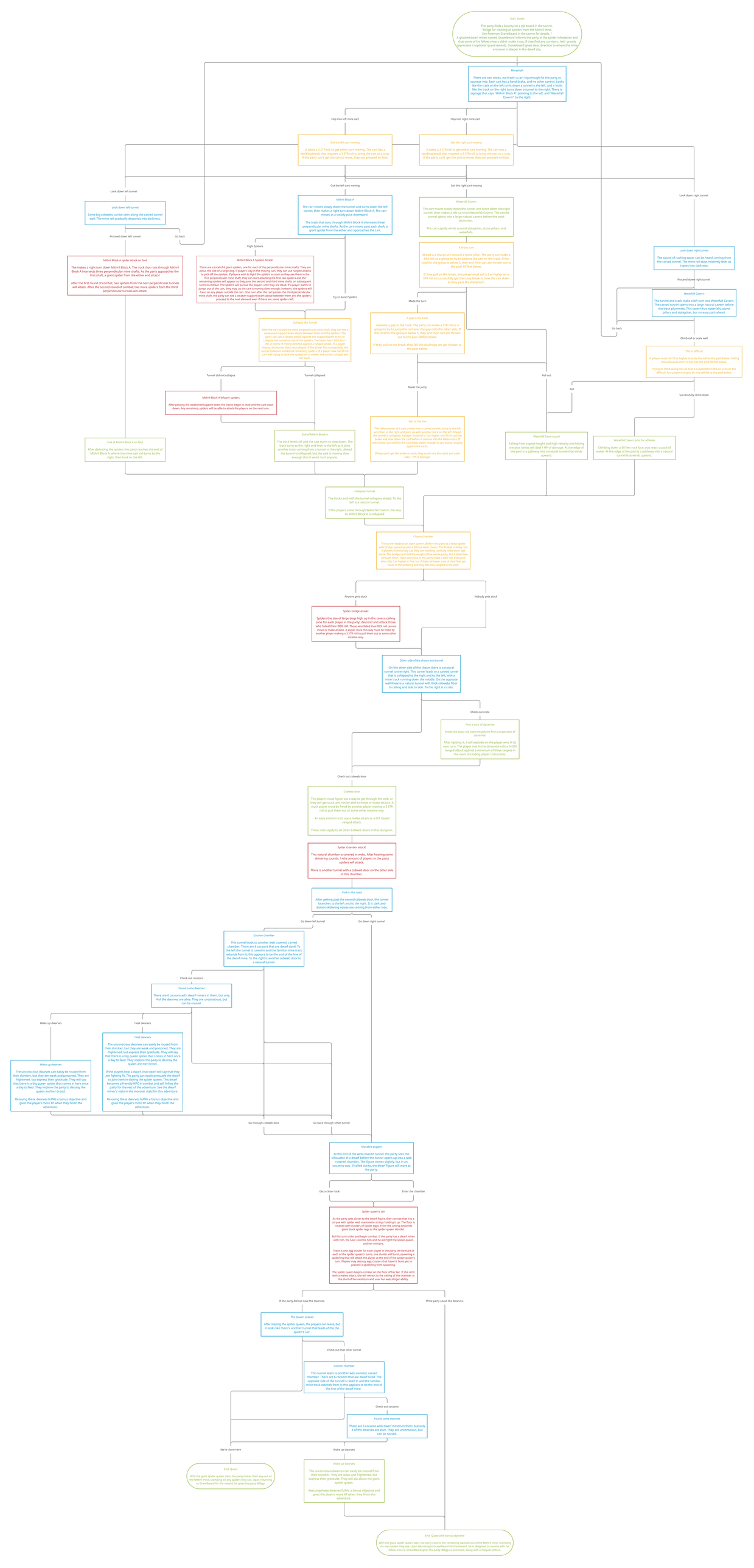
Start Quest
The party finds a bounty on a job board in the tavern. "Kobgz for sleeping in the Mithril Mine. See Foreman Gravelbeard in the tavern for details."
A grizzled dwarf miner named Gravelbeard informs the party of the spider infestation and that some of his fellow miners didn't make it out. If they find any survivors, he'd greatly appreciate it (optional quest reward). Gravelbeard gives clear direction to where the mine entrance is deeper in the dwarf city.
Mineshaft
There are two tracks, each with a cart big enough for the party to squeeze into. Each cart has a hand brake, and no other control. Looks like the track on the left turns down a tunnel to the left, and it looks like the track on the right turns down a tunnel to the right. There is signage that says "Mithril Block A" pointing to the left, and "Waterfall Cavern" to the right.
Hop into left mine cart
Hop into right mine cart
Get the left cart moving
It takes a 3 STR roll to get either cart moving. The cart has a working break that requires a 3 STR roll to bring the cart to a stop. If the party can't get the cart to move, they can proceed on foot.
Get the right cart moving
It takes a 3 STR roll to get either cart moving. The cart has a working break that requires a 3 STR roll to bring the cart to a stop. If the party can't get the cart to move, they can proceed on foot.
Look down left tunnel
Look down left tunnel
Some big cobwebs can be seen along the carved tunnel wall. The mine rail gradually descends into darkness.
Proceed down left tunnel
Go back
Got the left cart moving
Mithril Block A
The cart moves slowly down the tunnel and turns down the left tunnel, then makes a right turn down Mithril Block A. The cart moves at a steady pace downward.
The track that runs through Mithril Block A intersects three perpendicular mine shafts. As the cart moves past each shaft, a giant spider from the either end approaches the cart.
Fight Spiders
Mithril Block A Spiders Attack!
There are a total of 6 giant spiders, one for each of the perpendicular mine shafts. They are about the size of a large dog. If players stay in the moving cart, they can use ranged attacks to pick off the spiders. If players wish to fight the spiders as soon as they see them in the first perpendicular mine shaft, they can start attacking the first two spiders and the remaining spiders will appear as they pass the second and third mine shafts on subsequent rounds of combat. If players decide to jump out of the cart, they can. If the players do jump out of the cart, they may, as the cart is moving slow enough, however, the spiders will focus on any player outside the cart. One turn after the cart passes the third perpendicular mine shaft, the party can see a weaken support beam above between them and the spiders; proceed to the next element even if there are some spiders left.
Mithril Block A spider attack on foot
The makes a right turn down Mithril Block A. The track that runs through Mithril Block A intersects three perpendicular mine shafts. As the party approaches the first shaft, a giant spider from the either end attack!
After the first round of combat, two spiders from the next perpendicular tunnels will attack. After the second round of combat, two more spiders from the third perpendicular tunnels will attack.
Try to Avoid Spiders
Collapse the Tunnel
After the cart passes the third perpendicular mine shaft, they can see a weakened support beam above between them and the spiders. The beam is about 10 feet away and if the party succeeds in a ranged attack, they collapse the tunnel on top of the spiders. The beam has 1 DEX and 1 INT in terms of rolling defense against a ranged attack. If a player misses, the tunnel does not collapse. If the player hit successfully, the tunnel collapses and kill all remaining spiders. If a player was out of the cart and trying to take the spiders on in melee, the tunnel collapse will kill them.
Tunnel did not collapse
Tunnel collapsed
Mithril Block A leftover spiders
After passing the weakened support beam the tracks begin to level and the cart slows down. Any remaining spiders will be able to attack the players on the next turn.
End of Mithril Block A on foot
After defeating the spiders the party reaches the end of Mithril Block A, where the mine cart rail turns to the right, then back to the left.
End of Mithril Block A
The track levels off and the cart starts to slow down. The track turns to the right and then to the left as it joins another track coming from a tunnel to the right. Ahead the tunnel is collapsed, but the cart is moving slow enough that it won't hurt anyone.
Got the right cart moving
Waterfall Cavern
The cart moves slowly down the tunnel and turns down the right tunnel, then makes a left turn into Waterfall Cavern. The carved tunnel opens into a large natural cavern before the track plummets.
The cart rapidly winds around stalagtites, stone pillars, and waterfalls.
A sharp turn
Ahead is a sharp turn around a stone pillar. The party can make a DEX roll as a group to try to balance the cart on the track. If the total for the group is below 5, they and their cart are thrown out to the pool 50 feet below.
If they pull on the break, one player must roll a 3 or higher on a STR roll to successfully get the rusty break to slow the cart down as they pass the sharp turn.
Made the turn
A gap in the track
Ahead is a gap in the track. The party can make a STR roll as a group to try to jump the cart over the gap onto the other side. If the total for the group is below 5, they and their cart are thrown out to the pool 50 feet below.
If they pull on the break, they fail this challenge are get thrown to the pool below.
Made the jump
End of the line
The rollercoaster of a cart cruises into a carved tunnel, turns to the left and then to the right and joins up with another track on the left. Ahead the tunnel is collapsed. A player must roll a 3 or higher on STR to pull the brake and slow down the cart before it crashes into the fallen rocks. If they brake successfully the cart slows down enough to just bump roughly against the rocks.
If they can't get the brake to work, they crash into the rocks and each take 1 HP of damage.
Fell out
Fell
Waterfall Cavern pool
Falling from a great height and high velocity and hitting the pool below will deal 1 HP of damage. At the edge of the pool is a pathway into a natural tunnel that winds upward.
Look down right tunnel
Look down right tunnel
The sound of rushing water can be heard coming from the carved tunnel. The mine rail stays relatively level as it goes into darkness.
Proceed down right tunnel
Waterfall Cavern
The tunnel and track make a left turn into Waterfall Cavern. The carved tunnel opens into a large natural cavern before the track plummets. This cavern has waterfalls, stone pillars and stalagtites, but no easy path ahead.
Go back
Climb rail or scale wall
This is difficult
A player must roll 10 or higher to scale the wall to the pool below. Falling this will cause them to fall into the pool 50 feet below.
Trying to climb along the rail that is suspended in the air is much too difficult. Any player trying so do this will fall to the pool below.
Successfully climb down
Waterfall Cavern pool for athletes
Climbing down a 50 feet rock face, you reach a pool of water. At the edge of the pool is a pathway into a natural tunnel that winds upward.
Collapsed tunnel
The tracks end with the tunnel collapses ahead. To the left is a natural tunnel.
If the players came through Waterfall Cavern, the way to Mithril Block A is collapsed
Chasm chamber
The tunnel leads to an open cavern. Before the party is a large spider web bridge spanning over a 50 foot wide chasm. The bridge is sticky, but if players intentionally say they are treading carefully, they won't get stuck. The bridge can hold the weight of the whole party, but it does bow and sway under pressure. Anyone who gets stuck in the web, or those who rolls 3 or higher is fine, but if they roll lower, one of their feet get stuck in the webbing and they become tangled in the web.
Anyone gets stuck
Nobody gets stuck
Spider bridge attack!
Spiders the size of large dogs high up in the cavern ceiling (one for each player in the party) descend and attack those stuck in the web. Each spider has 1 attack against a stuck player, must or make attacks. A player stuck this way must be freed by another player making a 3 STR roll to pull them out or some other creative way.
Other side of the chasm and tunnel
On the other side of the chasm there is a natural tunnel to the right. This tunnel leads to a carved tunnel that is collapsed to the right and to the left, with a mine track running down the middle. On the opposite wall there is a natural tunnel with thick cobweb floor to ceiling and side to side. To the right is a crate.
Check out crate
Find a stick of dynamite
Inside the dusty old crate the players find a single stick of dynamite.
After lighting it, it will explode on the player who lit its next turn. The player that lit the dynamite rolls a 3-DEX ranged attack against a minimum of three targets in the room (including player characters).
Check out cobweb door
Cobweb door
The players must figure out a way to get through the web, or they will get stuck and not be able to move or make attacks. A stuck player must be freed by another player making a 3 STR roll to pull them out or some other creative way.
An easy solution is to use a melee attack or a INT based ranged attack.
These rules apply to all other Cobweb doors in this dungeon.
Spider chamber attack!
This natural chamber is covered in webs. After hearing some skittering sounds, 1+the amount of players in the party spiders will attack.
There is another tunnel with a cobweb door on the other side of this chamber.
Fork in the road
After getting past the second cobweb door, the tunnel branches to the left and to the right. It is dark and distant skittering noises are coming from either side.
Go down left tunnel
Go down right tunnel
Cocoon chamber
This tunnel leads to another web covered, carved chamber. There are 6 cocoons that are dwarf sized. To the left the tunnel is caved in and the familiar mine track extends from it; this appears to be the end of the line of the dwarf mine. To the right is another cobweb door to a natural tunnel.
Check out cocoons
Found some dwarves
There are 6 cocoons with dwarf miners in them, but only 4 of the dwarves are alive. They are unconscious, but can be roused.
Wake up dwarves
Heal dwarves
Wake up dwarves
The unconscious dwarves can easily be roused from their slumber, but they are weak and poisoned. They are frightened, but express their gratitude. They will say that there is a big queen spider that comes in here once a day to feed. They implore the party to destroy the queen and her brood.
Rescuing these dwarves fulfills a bonus objective and gives the players more XP when they finish the adventure.
Heal dwarves
The unconscious dwarves can easily be roused from their slumber, but they are weak and poisoned. They are frightened, but express their gratitude. They will say that there is a big queen spider that comes in here once a day to feed. They implore the party to destroy the queen and her brood.
If the players heal a dwarf, that dwarf will say that they are fighting fit. The party can easily persuade the dwarf to join them in slaying the spider queen. This dwarf becomes a Friendly NPC in combat and will follow the party for the rest of the adventure. See the dwarf miner's stats in the monster stats for this adventure.
Rescuing these dwarves fulfills a bonus objective and gives the players more XP when they finish the adventure.
Go through cobweb door
Go back through other tunnel
Macabre puppet
At the end of the web covered tunnel, the party sees the silhouette of a dwarf before the tunnel opens up into a well-covered chamber. The figure moves slightly, but in an uncanny way. If called out to, the dwarf figure will wave at the party.
Get a closer look
Enter the chamber
Spider queen's lair
As the party gets closer to the dwarf figure, they can see that it is a corpse with spider web threads wrapped holding it up. The floor is covered with clusters of spider eggs. From the ceiling descends giant black spider legs as the spider queen attacks!
Roll for turn order and begin combat. If the party has a dwarf miner with him, the Swe-controlled dwarf will fight the spider queen and her minions.
There is one egg cluster for each player in the party. At the start of each of the spider queen's turns, one cluster will burst, spawning a spiderling that will attack the player at the end of the spider queen's turn. Players may destroy egg clusters that haven't burst yet to prevent a spiderling from spawning.
The spider queen begins combat on the floor of her lair. If she is hit with a melee attack, she will retreat to the ceiling of the chamber at the start of her next turn and user her web stinger ability.
If the party did not save the dwarves.
If the party saved the dwarves.
The Queen is dead
After slaying the spider queen, the players can leave, but it looks like there's another tunnel that leads of the the queen's lair.
Check out that other tunnel
Cocoon chamber
This tunnel leads to another web covered, carved chamber. There are 6 cocoons that are dwarf sized. The opposite side of the tunnel is caved in and the familiar mine track extends from it; this appears to be the end of the line of the dwarf mine.
Check out cocoons
Found some dwarves
There are 6 cocoons with dwarf miners in them, but only 4 of the dwarves are alive. They are unconscious, but can be roused.
We're done here
Wake up dwarves
End Quest
With the giant spider queen slain, the party makes their way out of the Mithril mine, stomping on any spiders they see. Upon returning to Gravelbeard for the reward, he gives the party 400gp.
Wake up dwarves
The unconscious dwarves can easily be roused from their slumber. They are weak and frightened, but express their gratitude. They will ask about the giant spider queen.
Rescuing these dwarves fulfills a bonus objective and gives the players more XP when they finish the adventure.
End Quest with bonus objective
With the giant spider queen slain, the party escorts the remaining dwarves out of the Mithril mine, stomping on any spiders they see. Upon returning to Gravelbeard for the reward, he is delighted to be reunited with his fellow miners. Gravelbeard gives the party 400gp as promised, along with a magical lantern.